



INVESTING: Bhattacharya (left) with Salim Group's Chairman Anthony Salim

tion for 4,000 acres of land in Nandigram for a chemical SEZ in October 2006 but political violence shadowed the project.

In a bid to keep the SEZ-wary people of Bengal happy, the administration has named the public-private undertaking after legendary Bengali scientist Prafulla Chandra Roy. When Nayachar was sought as an alternative to Nandigram, environmentalists had warned of adverse ecological implications of the project on the island. Jadavpur University's findings, however, support Bhattacharya. CPI(M) journal *People's Democracy* states, "Researchers have put paid to the pseudo-scientific mumbo-jumbo of the opponents of Nayachar development." But the Salim Group finds no mention in the write-up. **by Satarupa Bhattacharya**

Nayachar is New Nandigram

DELHI Despite his party cadres "recapturing" Nandigram last year, West Bengal Chief Minister Buddhadeb Bhattacharya suffered moral defeat. The SEZ that he had promised to Indonesia's Salim Group did not take off even after the use of brute

force by CPI(M). Bhattacharya has now allocated 13,000 acres of land in the tidal island of Nayachar in east Midnapore to the group for a chemical hub. The island dwellers are from the fishing community. The New Kolkata International Develop-

ment Pvt Ltd (NKIDPL), a company promoted by the Salim Group, will hold 51 per cent stake with the remaining 49 per cent going to the state's Industrial Development Corporation. The Union Commerce Ministry had approved NKIDPL's applica-

THE BUZZ OF THE WEEK

After many son-rises, it is time now for the fairer sex. M. Karunanidhi's successful launch of daughter Kanimozhi has prompted PMK founder S. Ramadoss to induct his daughter into the rough and tumble of Indian politics.

VOICES



"Lalu Yadav resorts to tricks and raises (train) fares indirectly by altering rules. He gives with one hand and takes back with another."

Nitish Kumar, Bihar chief minister

"Can foul money merchandise India's batsmen and bowlers? Today cricketers, tomorrow ministers, MPs and others in learned professions will be auctioned."

V.R. Krishna Iyer, former Supreme Court judge

"The test of popularity of a judge among lawyers and litigants is how liberal he or she is in admitting cases and giving interim orders, often without touching the papers."

Somnath Chatterjee, Lok Sabha Speaker

"The nuke deal is a very good deal for India. (Opposing it) is a very good case of putting a bullet in the gift horse's forehead."

Strobe Talbott, former US deputy secretary of state

"I anticipated trouble after *Netaji Subhash Chandra Bose* and *Mangal Pandey*. But I didn't anticipate that people would say there is no Jodha. That came like a googly to me."

Ashutosh Gowariker, filmmaker

